

Companion papers: [Viktor Schauberger](#) (\$9.7 — where Keely first entered this network) · [Nikola Tesla](#) (his contemporary, and his verdict on him) · [Antigravity Devices](#) (what acoustic levitation actually lifts) · [Electrogravitics](#) (the field guide) · [Walter Russell](#) (the scorecard template)

# John Ernst Worrell Keely — Sympathetic Vibration, the Keely Motor, and the Cellar

*The record, the theory in his own words, the January-1899 excavation, and the physics of what a three-ton steel sphere full of air can actually do — written so the one genuinely traced fraud in this network's lineage is filed on evidence, and the one idea of his that survives is kept.*

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**What this paper is.** John Keely (1837–1898) ran, for twenty-four years, the best-funded and least-inspected private laboratory in America. He claimed to have found a force in water and air — “etheric,” “inter-atomic,” released by *sympathetic vibration* — that lifted weights, fired cannon, spun globes at the note of a violin, and would drive an airship. He never let an engineer inside a casing, went to prison rather than open one, and died with his secret. Two months later his patron's son rented the building, hired a physicist, an electrical engineer and a psychologist, and lifted every floorboard. This paper does four things. **Part I** reconstructs the documented record — dates, money, demonstrations, courts. **Part II** states his theory faithfully, in his words, and sorts it into what is testable and what is not. **Part III** reports the 1899 excavation exactly, including the defenders' counter-case, and files the verdict by the network's own forensic test. **Part IV** prices every load-bearing claim against textbook physics — the sphere, the tubes, the tuning forks, the levitation, the quartz — and names the residue that is real. The register is the companion papers': every claim tagged; the anti-reflex rule applied (never dismiss without doing the arithmetic); and the filter cutting both ways (never excuse a traced fraud because the idea beside it is beautiful).

Register tags used below: **DOCUMENTED** dated primary or contemporary press · **SINGLE-SOURCE** one partisan source or later reconstruction · **LEGEND** no traceable primary · **DERIVED** arithmetic on stated inputs · **TRACED FRAUD** named investigators, physical mechanism found · **OPEN** genuinely undecided.

**Guardrail, stated first.** This network's method (the Schauberger paper's \$0) forbids dismissing a claim because it sounds implausible or because the academy calls it fringe. It

permits setting a claim aside only when its best sources trace its provenance to fabrication — a named hoaxer, a staged film, a physical concealed mechanism found by named people. Keely is the case where that second test is *passed on the hardware*: named investigators, a physical mechanism, published the same week. So this paper is not a debunking by reflex; it is the forensic test returning positive. And the same discipline keeps what survives it: the resonance idea (Part IV.6) is a real ancestor of this network's own music-and-φ doctrine, and acoustic levitation is real at the milligram scale. Keep the idea; name the motor.

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## PART I — THE RECORD

### 1. Who Keely was, in dated facts

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- **DOCUMENTED** Born 3 September 1837, Pennsylvania (Chester or Philadelphia); orphaned young; earlier work variously listed as orchestra musician, painter, carpenter, carnival barker, mechanic. Died 18 November 1898, Philadelphia, of pneumonia; buried West Laurel Hill. Estate about \$10,000, all to his widow Anna; the will is silent on the motor.
- **DOCUMENTED** Workshop: 1422 North Twentieth Street, Philadelphia — rented — the building excavated in January 1899.
- **DOCUMENTED** First public demonstration 10 November 1874: he blew into a nozzle, added five gallons of tap water, and a gauge read “10,000 psi.” Witnesses formed a stock company on the spot; New England patent rights sold for \$50,000.

### 2. The company and the money

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**DOCUMENTED** The **Keely Motor Company** — founded 1872, headquartered in New York, capitalised at \$5,000,000 — sold stock for a quarter of a century on the promise of a motor that would run “a train from Philadelphia to New York on a quart of water.” In the 1879 “consolidation” the stock went from 20,000 to 100,000 shares, 40,000 of them to Keely for his inventions; the patron literature complains that fewer than 5,000 ever reached him and that “a half dozen or more” insiders cleared some \$50,000 each. *Scientific American* records that a single Navy gun demonstration (§3) sent the stock “from nine cents on the dollar to fifteen cents” in a day. John Jacob Astor IV bought in during November 1895.

**DOCUMENTED** Clara Jessup Bloomfield-Moore, the Philadelphia heiress and author, met Keely in 1881 and became his patron: about \$100,000 outright plus \$250 a month, raised from 1890 to \$2,000 a month for household and shop. She wrote *Keely and His Discoveries* (London, 1893), the principal primary compendium of his letters and her exposition of his theory. She was not uncritical: in November 1895 she commissioned Addison Burk (Spring Garden Institute) and the electrical engineer E. Alexander Scott to examine a demonstration; Scott tore the end off a “solid wire” and found it a thin hollow tube; a second, British Scott (W. Lascelles-Scott) spent a month and told the Franklin Institute Keely had shown “a force hitherto unknown”; the two Scotts disagreed; she asked Keely to cut the wire in front of them and he refused; she cut his allowance. She died in London on 5 January 1899 — the day before the sphere was found — and never saw the cellar.

**DOCUMENTED** The two great inventors of the age were asked. Edison, 30 August 1878: Keely was “only willing to show pressure” — he would not go “until he works an engine.” Tesla, to Bloomfield-Moore in the mid-1890s: “his method is an unscientific one”; “It is painful to read his theories”; “I pity him.” The trade journal *Electricity* (June 1895) offered to duplicate every Keely phenomenon within sixty days; the offer was ignored.

### 3. The demonstrations, as recorded

| Date    | What was shown                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Numbers claimed   | What was measured or noted at the time                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1874–78 | The “hydro-pneumatic-pulsating-vacu-engine,” then the “Generator”: spherical chambers linked by iron and copper tubes, ~3 tons, 5 × 5 × 2 ft; “one quart of water fills all the chambers.” Gauges, hissing, a lever lifting weights. | 10,000–11,000 psi | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> The chemist Charles M. Cresson analysed the “vapour”: “merely atmospheric air,” tube pressure 225 psi against 1,200 claimed. J. B. Knight (Franklin Institute secretary), after five months: gauges suspect, machinery “large and massive for the purpose of misleading,” true pressure “probably in no case exceeding 500 pounds.” A Franklin Institute committee (1877) “were not |

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|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                      | permitted to see anything but the results.”                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 20 Sep 1884, Sandy Hook         | The “vaporic gun” for the Navy: 1¼-in bore; wrought-iron magazine 3⅝ in × 4½ ft fed by a copper tube 3/16 in outside diameter; rubber gas-check discs; nineteen rounds; 5-oz lead ball.                                                                   | 7,000 psi used, 30,000 possible                                                      | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> Velocities 483–528 ft/s, ball through 3–4 in of pine at 300–500 yd. Lt. E. L. Zalinski (the pneumatic dynamite-gun officer) said the delay before each shot was “requisite for the bursting of the diaphragms” and offered to duplicate it with compressed air; <i>Scientific American</i> did — a brass 1-in gun, rubber discs bursting at 1,300–1,500 psi, ball through 6+ in of pine. Two months later Keely claimed 50,000 psi and “all gauges broken,” refused Zalinski's 10,000-psi gauge: “I do not believe in pressure gauges, anyhow.” |
| 6 Jun 1885, workshop            | Violin bow on tuning forks → hiss → lever lifts weights; an iron globe on an axle saws wood.                                                                                                                                                              | ~22,000 psi; a witness computes ½-in <sup>2</sup> piston, 580-lb weight ⇒ 18,900 psi | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> The globe ran under fifteen minutes with declining power. About twenty witnesses; no one inside a casing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 26 Mar 1886, New York committee | Pressure demonstration.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2,700 psi “from a pint of water”                                                     | Later retold as 50,000.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 1878–95                         | “Vibratory lift” — metal spheres (six ounces each) rising and falling in a 40-in water/glycerin column at the pitch of a zither; the “musical globe” revolving across the room as forks are bowed, stopping when a volunteer steps outside a wire circle. | —                                                                                    | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> Hering (1899): the column device “nothing more than a Cartesian diver.” Kinraide's 1899 teardown of the Globe Motor: a “heavy coiled spring” with gearing, released by a diaphragm brake ( <i>New York Journal</i> , 29 Jan 1899).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1888    | “Disintegration” of quartz rock by vibration.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | —                     | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> Keely himself (1893): “repeatedly urged to repeat my disintegrations of quartz” but the device was “destroyed at the time of the proceedings against me.” <b>LEGEND</b> The “18-ft tunnel through quartz in 18 minutes for gold-mine investors” story circulates in later esoteric literature with no primary citation. |
| 1893–97 | The airship: “a model of an air-ship, weighing about eight pounds” that rose, hovered and descended on a silver-platinum wire (Bloomfield-Moore's introduction, 1893); a ~200-lb “etheric engine” shown to Manhattan Elevated and Western Union men, 18 Jun 1897, claiming 10 hp. | 8 lb lifted;<br>10 hp | No instrument; no engineer inside.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## 4. The courts

- **DOCUMENTED** 1881–83 stockholders' suit: complaints of “deception and misrepresentation” (14 Dec 1881); Judge Pierce orders Keely to “make known his process” (1 Apr 1882); William Boekel appointed to be instructed (Jun 1882); never instructed (Aug 1883).
- **DOCUMENTED** Bennett C. Wilson suit (a claimed half-share from an 1860s agreement): injunction 3 Jan 1888; four experts (Cresson, Shaw, Marks, Naylor) ordered to inspect (7 Apr 1888); Keely refuses; **jailed for contempt in Moyamensing Prison, 17 November 1888**; bailed 20 November; the Pennsylvania Supreme Court reverses the inspection order as premature (28 Jan 1889). Two months later counsel announces the “missing link,” a copper loop tube.

- **DOCUMENTED** After his death: T. Burton Kinraide of Boston (X-ray-coil maker) named successor (20 Dec 1898); twenty packing cases shipped to Jamaica Plain (Jan 1899); Kinraide abandons the work (6 May 1899) and issues further damning statements (July 1899).

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## PART II — THE THEORY, IN HIS WORDS

### 5. Sympathetic vibratory physics

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Stated faithfully, from his letters as printed in Bloomfield-Moore (1893) and the contemporary press. Short quotations only, attributed. The vocabulary is his and hers; where a modern formulation is a later reconstruction, it is marked.

| Term                                        | His words                                                                                                                                                                      | Reading: testable / not                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Etheric force                               | 1884: the machine “liberates from the air and water an inter atomic ether”; the ether is “about four times lighter than ... hydrogen gas.”                                     | Testable in principle (a fluid four times lighter than hydrogen would have a measurable density and would not be air) — Cresson's analysis found air.  |
| Sympathetic vibration / negative attraction | Keely “calls this power ... ‘sympathetic negative attraction’ ” (B-M). Bodies tuned to the same chord couple; matter is “disintegrated” by striking its chord.                 | Half real, half not (Part IV.6): resonance and sympathetic coupling are real and never amplify; “disintegration by chord” at the claimed scale is not. |
| Neutral centre                              | “the neutral centre is free from its intensification”; “the neutral centre represents the human heart” (B-M).                                                                  | Metaphysical; no measurable referent.                                                                                                                  |
| Subdivisions of matter                      | “molecular, inter-molecular, atomic, inter-atomic, etheric, inter-etheric” — “seven distinct orders” (B-M).                                                                    | A ladder without units; unfalsifiable as stated.                                                                                                       |
| Thirds, sixths, ninths                      | On disintegrating water: “the instrument is set on thirds, sixths, and ninths.”<br><b>SINGLE-SOURCE</b> The modern “3-6-9 ratio,” “40 octaves,” and “Keely's 40 laws” are Dale | Harmonic ratios are real music theory; the claim that they open matter is not shown.                                                                   |

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|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
|                        | Pond's reconstructions and do not appear in the 1893 text.                                                                                                   |                                                    |
| Chord of mass          | "obtaining the keynote, or 'chord of mass' " of a body lets it be lifted or held (B-M); the six-ounce spheres in the water column.                           | Testable — and tested in 1899 (Cartesian diver).   |
| Triune / polar streams | "one of the triune currents of the polar stream"; electricity is "harmonic, enharmonic, and diatonic" currents; "polar negative attractor"; "depolar disks." | Metaphysical.                                      |
| Aerial navigation      | The eight-pound airship model "rose, descended, or remained stationary" at will (B-M introduction).                                                          | Testable; never instrumented; priced in Part IV.4. |

**What is real in it, stated once.** Keely's root intuition — that a body couples to its medium most strongly at resonance, and that "sympathy" between tuned things is how energy moves — is not wrong. It is the physics of coupled oscillators, sympathetic strings, mode-matching, and every resonant cavity this network builds. Where he went wrong is stated in Part IV: resonance *selects* and *stores*; it never *multiplies*. Nothing in a bowed fork can saw wood.

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## PART III — THE CELLAR, JANUARY 1899

### 6. The sequence, dated

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1. **DOCUMENTED** **6 January 1899.** With the motor already crated for Boston, a large steel sphere is found under the workshop floor, "buried in the ground ... on a solid stone foundation." Keely's associate Dr. Thomas: it "weighs about 6,000 pounds" and was used "over ten years ago in ... levitation." The company secretary, Schuellerman, next day: a cast-steel sphere made "many years ago by the Chester Steel Casting Company" as reservoir for the "multiplier or generator" — **42 in diameter, 30 in cavity, 6,625 lb**; the whole multiplier 6,800 lb; the machine long sold as scrap, the globe kept "as a weight," with "no wire communication with any other apparatus."

2. **DOCUMENTED** **Clarence B. Moore** — Bloomfield-Moore's son, who had fought his mother in court over her spending on Keely — rents the premises and on 16–17 January brings in **Carl Hering** (consulting electrical engineer), **Arthur W. Goodspeed** (assistant professor of physics, University of Pennsylvania), **Lightner Witmer** (professor of experimental psychology, Penn), Dr. M. G. Miller (excavation), Coleman Sellers Jr., the carpenter and gas-fitter George W. Arnold, and the engineer E. A. Scott (who had torn the “wire” open in 1895). Private detectives guard the site. Every floorboard is lifted; a brick wall is opened.
3. **DOCUMENTED** **19 January 1899, *Philadelphia Press***, illustrated, with signed statements. Goodspeed: “many small tubes imbedded in the walls and concealed under floors ... little larger than wires ... designed for standing high pressures,” one of them “nearly under ... where the heavy lever testing device used to stand”; the sphere could withstand “20,000 to 100,000 pounds to the square inch.” Hering: “a very little air at a very great pressure can develop considerable power” through “extremely fine tubes”; one device “nothing more than a Cartesian diver”; Keely “probably lied and deceived” and used “highly compressed air.” A water/sewer connection torn out in one corner — “there may have been a water motor there”; a disconnected insulated electric wire over a second-floor window.
4. **DOCUMENTED** **20 January, *New York Times***, “Keely's Secret Disclosed”: “adroitly hidden pipes leading downward through the floor,” “a hollow steel sphere weighing three tons,” tubes “for no other purposes than the conveyance of air or gases under great pressure” — adding, fairly, that “these things do not, of course, demonstrate that Keely did not turn his wheels with a new force.”
5. **DOCUMENTED** **28 January, *Scientific American* 80(4):59–60**, “The Keely Motor Fraud”: “hidden beneath the floor ... a large and massive metal sphere, whose weight is given as three tons”; “hidden in the brick wall, a quantity of small brass tubing, of just the size and strength to match ... the steel reservoir”; “underneath the upper floor ... a false ceiling, well calculated to hide the necessary tubes”; “a number of trap-doors ... scattered over the floor.” Verdict: “this most colossal humbug of the century” ran on “compressed air.” (The often-repeated “bell-metal” tubing does not appear in *Scientific American*, the *Times*, or *Paijmans*; the primary word is *brass*.)
6. **DOCUMENTED** **29 January, *New York Journal***: statements by the widow's lawyer and a former assistant; cross-section drawings of double floors and ceilings, shafts

and belts to a **water motor** in the basement started by a rubber bulb on a rubber tube; a “small, well-worn belt” between pulleys; a trap door under a box and oilcloth; the latest “transmitter” with a hidden rubber diaphragm, piston, harmonica and hollow wire. Kinraide's Boston teardown finds the coiled spring in the Globe Motor.

## 7. The defenders' case, fairly stated

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- **DOCUMENTED** The sphere *was* an old reservoir for the “multiplicator,” publicly described a decade earlier and kept as a weight — this is contemporary testimony from company officers (Schuellerman, Collier, Thomas), not a later invention; it was buried and disconnected when found. The company president Ackerman (25–26 Jan): the tubes were discarded years earlier, since 1887 only solid wires were used, and the concealed wire was a burglar alarm; the directors “reaffirmed their faith.”
- **SINGLE-SOURCE** The Sympathetic Vibratory Physics community (Dale Pond, SVPwiki): the tubes distributed “etheric vapour” the way a shop distributes air; Clarence Moore was hostile and “brought no physicist, engineer, scientist”; the press was “owned by monopolists”; a “Major Seaver” found no hollow wires. The first is an assertion; the second is contradicted by the record (Goodspeed was a physicist, Hering an engineer); the third is offered without evidence; the fourth is uncited.
- **DOCUMENTED** The fairest sympathetic biographer, Theo Paijmans (*Free Energy Pioneer*, 1998), grants that the investigators “were prejudiced from the start,” stresses that *no photographs of the dismantled engines' interiors exist — only drawings and statements*, and leaves Kinraide's silence-then-confession “never resolved.” He renders no verdict.

**Verdict — **TRACED FRAUD**, on the network's own test.** The Schauberger paper's \$0 forensic test asks for a physical concealed mechanism, found and documented by named people. Here it is: a three-ton pressure vessel and pressure tubing in the walls and under the very spot the lever tests were run, found by a named physicist and a named engineer, published in the daily and the technical press the same week; a hollow “wire” torn open by a named engineer four years earlier; a coiled spring found in the “musical globe” by the inventor's own chosen successor; a chemist's air analysis and a Franklin Institute officer's “ $\leq 500$  psi” two decades

before; two independent compressed-air replications of the gun; and twenty-four years of refusing every inspection, including one that cost him a prison cell. Paijmans is right that the engine interiors were drawn, not photographed — that is why the sphere, the wall tubing and the false ceiling, which *were* photographed and measured, carry the verdict on their own. The defenders' strongest point — the sphere was old and disconnected — is compatible with the finding: a reservoir that had served its purpose was buried, and the fine tubing that fed the later shows stayed in the walls. Contrast this with Schauburger, whose machine was real, whose flight claims sit in his own letters, and whose sin was never measuring; and with Tesla, who kept the books. Keely alone in this lineage *built the deception into the floor*. Not by plausibility — by evidence.

**DOCUMENTED** One further discipline: Keely is *not* a suppression case, and this network should not be tempted to file him as one. He was funded lavishly and continuously for a quarter of a century by private money, courted by the Navy, protected by a state supreme court, and never once compelled to open a casing. No agency erased his files; he took them to the grave. The suppression frame this project holds for other figures gets no purchase here, and applying it would discredit the cases where it does.

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## PART IV — THE PHYSICS, PRICED

### 8. The sphere

**DERIVED** Take the secretary's numbers: 42 in outside diameter, 30 in cavity, 6,625 lb. The cavity holds 232 litres; the shell volume is  $0.40 \text{ m}^3$ , which at  $7,800 \text{ kg/m}^3$  is 3,150 kg — self-consistent with 6,625 lb of slightly porous cast steel. The wall is six inches thick. Thick-sphere hoop stress at the bore is  $1.36 \times p$ ; cast steel yields at 200–400 MPa, so the vessel yields at roughly **21,000–43,000 psi**. Goodspeed's lower bound (“20,000”) is exactly right; his upper (“100,000”) is generous. The point stands: *the sphere could hold the 20,000–25,000 psi that Keely's lever demonstrations required*.

**DERIVED** Stored isothermal work is  $pV \cdot \ln(p/p_0)$ . At 1,000 psi the sphere holds 6.7 MJ (1.9 kWh); at 5,000 psi, 47 MJ; at 20,000 psi, of order 200 MJ (the ideal-gas figure overestimates at that density, but the order is right). Lifting a 580-lb weight six inches costs 387 J. **One charge would run thousands of lever lifts.** A  $\frac{1}{2}$ -in<sup>2</sup> piston at 20,000 psi delivers 10,000 lbf. The air mass at 20,000 psi is about 380 kg — hours of pumping

by a hidden water motor, which is exactly what the *Journal's* drawings show and exactly why shows were spaced by weeks.

## 9. The tubes and the gun

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**DERIVED** A 1/32-in bore at 1,000+ psi passes enough air to run a small air motor, lift a lever, or inflate a Cartesian diver, and a 1/8-in outside diameter hides such a bore from a spectator across a room; the Sandy Hook feed tube was 3/16 in outside diameter — a “wire” to the eye. *Scientific American's* 1884 replication needed only **1,300–1,500 psi** to match the gun; Cresson's measured 225 psi and Knight's “ $\leq 500$  psi” suffice for the early lever shows. The claimed **50,000 psi (345 MPa)** exceeds the yield of any 1880s hose, fitting or gauge — which is why “all gauges broken” and a refused 10,000-psi gauge are *diagnostic*, not incidental: a rubber or leather hose bursts at a few hundred psi, so “bursting hoses” is compatible with modest air pressure and incompatible with the number claimed for it.

## 10. Tuning forks and the sawing globe

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**DERIVED** A tuning-fork tine (10 g, 1 mm excursion, 440 Hz) stores about 0.04 J and radiates milliwatts; a bowed fork delivers well under a watt. Sympathetic coupling between tuned bodies transfers at most the source's own energy, within a  $1/Q$  bandwidth — it selects and stores, it never amplifies. A globe sawing wood for fifteen minutes at even 0.1 hp is  $\sim 70$  kJ, a million times a fork's store. Bloomfield-Moore's claim that “a thousand tuning forks” would make “noise far greater than the original” is simply energy conservation stated backwards.

## 11. Levitation, real and claimed

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**DOCUMENTED** Acoustic levitation is real, and this network builds it: Kundt (1866) showed dust collecting at standing-wave nodes; Rayleigh (1902) gave the radiation pressure; Bücks and Müller (1933) first levitated droplets; TinyLev (Marzo, Barnes & Drinkwater, *Rev. Sci. Instrum.* 88:085105, 2017) lifts millimetre beads and insects with 10 W at 40 kHz; Xie and Wei (*PRL* 2002) held iridium and mercury drops at  $> 160$  dB. The companion [bench-floor paper](#) gives the ceilings.

**DERIVED** To hold Keely's eight-pound (3.6 kg) airship over  $\sim 0.05 \text{ m}^2$  needs an acoustic energy density of  $\sim 700 \text{ J/m}^3$  — about 10 kPa rms, i.e.  **$\sim 174 \text{ dB}$** , a shock field that would deafen the room. Not a zither. Six-ounce spheres rising and falling in a 40-in water column at a change of pitch is, as Hering said, a Cartesian diver: a sealed float whose buoyancy is set by the pressure of the air above the column — pressure that a fine tube from a reservoir supplies invisibly.

## 12. Quartz

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**DERIVED** Ultrasonic machining is real (Balamuth's Cavitron, 1945): 20–40 kHz at 100 W–kW with abrasive slurry drills glass and quartz at cubic-millimetres per second; cavitation erodes surfaces slowly. An 18-ft  $\times$  4.5-ft tunnel in quartz ( $\sim 8 \text{ m}^3$ ,  $\sim 21 \text{ t}$ ) in eighteen minutes would demand tens of megawatts of comminution power — no acoustic source then or now. Keely's own 1893 text concedes he could not repeat the quartz demonstration.

## 13. What survives — the residue

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- **Resonance as the coupling key.** The idea that a body couples to its medium at resonance, and that “sympathy” between tuned things is how energy is exchanged, is a genuine ancestor of this network's own doctrine — the chamber read “in the analogy of music,” mode-matching as the coupling lever,  $\phi$ -ratio plateaus in the coupling matrix. The [Schauberger paper](#) §9.7 places Keely in the same convergence table as Schauburger and Pais on exactly this point: *concept real, device a traced fraud*. This paper confirms both halves.
- **Acoustic levitation.** Real at the milligram-to-gram scale, priced and built in [Antigravity Devices](#); forbidden at human scale by the 194-dB ceiling. Keely's water-column and airship “levitations” are not instances of it.
- **The vaporic gun.** A working compressed-air gun — the same technology Zalinski was fielding for the Navy at the time. Real, and not his.

## 14. Scorecard

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| Claim                                                                                                                      | Register                                                               | Reading                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Keely Motor Company<br>1872–1899; \$5 M<br>capitalisation; Bloomfield-<br>Moore patronage; Astor<br>investment             | <b>DOCUMENTED</b>                                                      | Company, press and court record.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Demonstrations of<br>pressure, lever lifts, the<br>gun, the globe, the water-<br>column “levitation,” the<br>airship model | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> as<br>events;<br><b>TRACED FRAUD</b> as<br>mechanism | Contemporary air analysis (Cresson), $\leq 500$<br>psi (Knight), hollow wire (Scott 1895), two<br>compressed-air replications of the gun, then<br>the 1899 sphere, wall tubing, false ceiling,<br>trapdoors, water motor, and the spring in the<br>globe — named investigators, physical<br>mechanism. |
| Jailed for contempt 17 Nov<br>1888 rather than permit<br>inspection                                                        | <b>DOCUMENTED</b>                                                      | Moyamensing Prison; reversed on appeal Jan<br>1889.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Etheric force “four times<br>lighter than hydrogen”;<br>50,000 psi from a pint of<br>water                                 | <b>REFUTED</b>                                                         | Air; nothing in the room could contain 50,000<br>psi.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Quartz tunnel in 18<br>minutes                                                                                             | <b>LEGEND</b>                                                          | No primary; tens of MW required; he could<br>not repeat quartz work by his own account.                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| “40 laws,” “40 octaves,”<br>“3-6-9”                                                                                        | <b>SINGLE-SOURCE</b>                                                   | Dale Pond reconstructions; not in the 1893<br>primary.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Sympathetic vibration as<br>coupling principle                                                                             | <b>DOCUMENTED</b> (as<br>physics of resonance)                         | Real; selects and stores, never multiplies. The<br>residue this network keeps.                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Keely as a suppressed<br>inventor                                                                                          | <b>REFUTED</b>                                                         | Funded 24 years, courted by the Navy,<br>protected by a court, never inspected. The<br>frame does not apply.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Modern replication with<br>measurement                                                                                     | <b>OPEN</b> — none exists                                              | The SVP “Dynaspheres” report no<br>independent measurement.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

## 15. What a drone company should take from Keely

1. **The forensic test is the whole method.** Do not dismiss Keely because his vocabulary is strange; dismiss the motor because named people found the pipes. The same test, run on Schauberger, returns “unmeasured,” and on Tesla “documented” — three different verdicts from one procedure. That is what makes the procedure worth trusting.
2. **“I do not believe in gauges” is the tell.** Every claim in this network's own bench program is required to name the instrument that would kill it. A refused gauge, a broken gauge, a casing no one may open — those are the diagnostic, not the mystique.
3. **Resonance is a selector, not a source.** Mode-matching is how this network intends to couple to a medium; it is not how it intends to get energy from one. Keely's error and Schauberger's have the same shape — a store mistaken for a source — and the ledger discipline in [The Warp Drive](#) §2 exists to refuse it.

## References & receipts

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- *Scientific American* 80(4):59–60, 28 January 1899, “The Keely Motor Fraud” (full text read); also “The Keely Motor Deception,” July 1875 and May 1881; the 11 October 1884 Sandy Hook report and compressed-air replication.
- *Philadelphia Press*, 19 January 1899 (illustrated; signed statements of Goodspeed, Hering, Witmer et al.); *New York Times*, 20 January 1899, “Keely's Secret Disclosed”; *New York Journal*, 29 January 1899 (drawings of the double floors, water motor, spring in the Globe Motor). NYT coverage 1875–1899 as indexed by the Wikipedia article.
- Clara Jessup Bloomfield-Moore, *Keely and His Discoveries: Aerial Navigation* (London: Kegan Paul, Trench, Trübner, 1893; Project Gutenberg #56332) — the primary compendium of Keely's letters and the source of every quotation in Part II.
- Theo Paijmans, *Free Energy Pioneer: John Worrell Keely* (IllumiNet 1998; AUP 2004) — the fullest biography, sympathetic and careful; source for the excavation sequence (pp. 142–160), the Franklin Institute and Cresson findings, the Edison and Tesla letters, and the caution that engine interiors were drawn, not photographed.
- Carl Hering, retrospective (1924), and Donald Simanek, “The Keely Motor Company,” with Hering excerpt; A. W. J. G. Ord-Hume, *Perpetual Motion: The*

*History of an Obsession* (1977); Museum of Hoaxes, “The Keely Motor Company.”

- Sympathetic Vibratory Physics (Dale Pond), SVPwiki “Was Keely a Fraud” and the Dale Pond page — the defenders' case, quoted fairly in §7; rexresearch.com Keely compilation.
- Physics: Marzo, Barnes & Drinkwater, “TinyLev,” *Rev. Sci. Instrum.* 88:085105 (2017); Xie & Wei, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* 89:104304 (2002); Rayleigh, *Phil. Mag.* (1902) “On the pressure of vibrations”; Balamuth, ultrasonic machining (1945). Sphere and tube arithmetic in §§8–9 on the secretary's stated dimensions.
- Companions: [viktor\\_schauberger.html](#) §0 (the forensic test) and §9.7 (the Keely row); [nikola\\_tesla.html](#); [antigravity\\_devices.html](#) (acoustic ceilings); [walter\\_russell.html](#) (scorecard template).

## Changelog

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- v1.0 · 2026-08-18 — first draft, written for the People shelf of the public paper site. Keely previously appeared in this network only as one row of the Schauberger paper's §9.7 convergence table; this paper carries that row's verdict — concept real, device a traced fraud — with the full record behind it.